

Double Diamond

Discover · Define · Develop · Deliver — diverge and converge twice

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Double Diamond depicts design as two linked diamonds: the first (**Discover** → **Define**) explores then frames the problem; the second (**Develop** → **Deliver**) explores then delivers the solution. Each diamond widens (divergent) before it narrows (convergent), stressing that problem and solution each need exploration.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Introduced by the UK Design Council in 2004 after studying the design processes of leading firms.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Organisations tend to rush to solutions before understanding the problem. The model visually insists on 'designing the right thing' before 'designing the thing right'.

FIGURE 1 · PROCESS VIEW

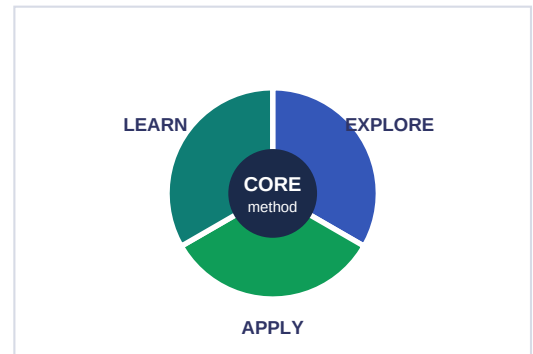


Figure 1. Double Diamond framed as a continuous, iterative method — explore, apply and learn cycle back through the work rather than run once.

HOW IT IS USED

Teams consciously diverge and converge in each diamond, using research tools in Discover, framing tools in Define, ideation and prototyping in Develop, and testing and launch in Deliver.

WHEN IT IS USED

For framing and running an end-to-end project, and for communicating process to stakeholders who need a simple map.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Design leaders, service designers, consultancies and cross-functional teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO PRIOR PRACTICE

It adds an explicit **problem diamond** that many linear models omit, embedding divergent–convergent discipline into the shape itself.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

d.school 5-Stage Model *Slibrary 3*

Divergent–Convergent Thinking *Slibrary 1*

Point of View (PoV) *Slibrary 6*

SOURCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Design Council (2005) *The Double Diamond*. London: Design Council.

Design Council (2019) *Framework for Innovation*. London: Design Council.